

Code of Conduct and Workplace Behavior Policy

This policy describes expected professional behavior, decision-making standards, reporting channels, and investigation principles that support a safe and respectful workplace.

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1.0 Purpose

The code of conduct establishes a consistent enterprise standard for respectful communication, ethical decision-making, protection of confidential information, and appropriate workplace behavior across every function of the company. In a production-level knowledge base, employees should be able to retrieve both the expected standard and the action to take when something goes wrong.

The policy is designed to reduce ambiguity in difficult situations. It explains the conduct that is required, the conduct that is prohibited, and the practical reporting routes employees can use when they need help, witness misconduct, or believe a decision may conflict with company values, legal obligations, or employee safety.

2.0 Scope

This policy applies to employees, contractors, interns, managers, and executives in all work settings, including remote collaboration, meetings, travel, chat channels, email, company events, and interactions with customers, candidates, partners, and vendors.

The policy covers both daily collaboration norms and serious misconduct concerns. It should be read alongside information security policies, anti-harassment requirements, expense rules, and local employment law guidance where additional obligations exist.

- Applies to in-person, virtual, and travel-related work interactions.
- Covers verbal conduct, written conduct, system usage, and decision-making behavior.
- Requires escalation to HR, Security, or Legal when a matter creates safety, privacy, or compliance risk.

3.0 Responsibilities

The responsibilities below define who must act, approve, review, and maintain records so the process can be executed consistently across teams and audit periods.

3.1 All Personnel

- Communicate respectfully, protect confidential information, and raise concerns in good faith when something appears unsafe or inappropriate.
- Avoid retaliatory behavior, conflicts of interest, or misuse of systems, privileges, or company resources.
- Cooperate honestly with fact-finding, policy reviews, or required compliance training.

3.2 Managers

- Model the expected standard in daily communication, feedback, and decision-making.
- Respond promptly to reported concerns and involve HR rather than attempting to resolve serious matters informally.
- Protect employees from retaliation and ensure corrective actions are implemented when required.

3.3 Human Resources

- Maintain the policy, guide investigations, and coordinate with Legal or Security when needed.
- Provide confidential reporting routes and protect sensitive records according to retention requirements.
- Track themes, policy acknowledgements, and remediation activities for governance review.

4.0 Expected Standards of Conduct

Professional behavior includes how people disagree, not just how they agree. Employees are expected to discuss tradeoffs directly, challenge ideas with evidence, and avoid sarcasm, exclusion, intimidation, or repeated dismissive behavior that undermines participation or psychological safety.

Ethical conduct also includes stewardship of systems and information. Employees should use company assets only for authorized work purposes, avoid conflicts of interest in hiring or vendor decisions, and protect sensitive internal, employee, and customer information from unauthorized disclosure.

4.1 Respectful Communication

- Use clear, professional language in meetings, chat, documentation, and email.
- Address disagreements through evidence, decision records, and escalation paths rather than personal attacks.
- Create space for others to contribute and avoid interrupting, humiliating, or excluding colleagues.

4.2 Ethical and Secure Conduct

- Disclose actual or perceived conflicts of interest before participating in a decision.
- Handle confidential records only through approved systems and workflows.
- Follow legal, privacy, and security requirements whenever sensitive information is involved.

5.0 Prohibited Conduct and Risk Indicators

The company treats harassment, discrimination, bullying, retaliation, threats, deliberate privacy violations, and abuse of system access as serious policy breaches. Repeated low-grade behavior can also become misconduct when it creates a hostile or exclusionary environment over time.

Managers should not wait for absolute certainty before escalating a serious concern. If a behavior pattern raises safety, privacy, or retaliation risk, the matter should be referred to HR promptly so evidence can be preserved and the response can be proportionate, consistent, and well-documented.

- Harassment, discriminatory treatment, or intimidation based on protected characteristics or other inappropriate factors.
- Unauthorized disclosure of confidential company, employee, customer, or candidate information.
- Abuse of company systems, credentials, procurement processes, expense policies, or managerial authority.
- Threatening behavior, physical aggression, or deliberate damage to company property or employee safety.

6.0 Reporting, Investigation, and Resolution

Employees are encouraged to raise concerns early through their manager, Human Resources, or the confidential ethics channel. Where a concern involves a direct manager, a sensitive employee issue, or a possible retaliation risk, employees should bypass the local chain of command and use HR or the ethics route directly.

Investigations are coordinated by HR, with Legal, Security, and business leaders involved as needed. Outcomes depend on the severity and evidence of the matter and may range from coaching and training to access restrictions, formal disciplinary action, reassignment, or termination.

- Document the concern with dates, people involved, and available evidence where possible.
- Protect confidentiality on a need-to-know basis during the review period.
- Communicate required corrective actions to relevant leaders and track completion.

7.0 Exceptions and Escalation

No manager or employee may create an exception that permits harassment, retaliation, misuse of confidential information, or other prohibited conduct. If a local practice appears to conflict with this policy, HR must review and document the resolution.

Incidents involving physical safety, data exposure, or suspected retaliation should be escalated immediately to HR and the relevant specialist function. The priority is to protect people and preserve evidence before the matter becomes harder to investigate responsibly.

8.0 Records and Review

Policy acknowledgements, investigation records, and corrective action evidence must be stored in approved HR systems with access restricted to authorized personnel. Informal chat history should not be treated as the only record for serious matters.

HR reviews conduct themes, mandatory training completion, and open remediation items at least quarterly. The policy is refreshed annually, with earlier updates when legal requirements, reporting channels, or governance expectations change.